giftly

# we help *agents* find products you *love*.

THE MARKET

# by 2030, agentic commerce is a *$3–5T* economy.

SHIPPED IN THE LAST 6 MONTHS

- ChatGPT Shopping
- Perplexity Shopping
- Amazon Rufus
- Walmart Sparky
- Gemini Shopping

THE RAILS ARE BUILT

- **ACP** Agentic Commerce Protocol
- **UCP** Universal Commerce Protocol
- **AP2** Agent Payments Protocol
- **MCP** Model Context Protocol
- **A2A** Agent-to-Agent

*50M*
ChatGPT shopping queries per day

*1M+*
Shopify merchants onboarding (Glossier, SKIMS, Spanx, Vuori)

*10–20%*
of purchases handled by agents by 2030

*whoever owns the signal owns the next economy.*

THE PROBLEM

# agents can't tell the difference between a product that's *well marketed* and a product that's *actually great*.

- × advertising
- × SEO & GEO
- × reviews
- × paid placement

*30%*

of online reviews are fake — and rising with AI bot spam.

*275M*

fake reviews Amazon let through in 2024 despite $500M and 8,000 employees.

*83%*

of consumers don't trust AI shopping agents — and they're right not to.

*we think the best products should win.*

THE ANSWER

# *giftly is the ground truth for product quality.*

the API every agent queries before they buy.

trygiftly.com

THE TRUST LAYER

# the largest network of *human evaluators* on earth.

| NETWORK | | OUTPUT | | CONSUMER |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| creators · experts · verified buyers | → | honest, structured product data | → | your shopping agent |

*every agent shopping with our data pays us.*

# *today*, our evaluators are *content creators*.

*01* brands send creators free products

*02* creators post only if they love them

*03* creators earn affiliate commission on every sale

*every match adds evaluation data to the long-term dataset.*

# in *1 week*, our network secured:

*50*

vetted creators

*~2M*

combined reach

*7*

official brand partnerships

*$300M*

combined partner valuation

THE PATH

# three phases. *12 months* to seed.

*pre-PearX*
NOW → JUL 2026

→ contributor network *50 → 5,000*, brand network *7 → 300* — all organic
→ ship v1 product: creator + brand portals, gifting workflow
→ first *MCP integration* live

*PearX*
JUL → OCT 2026

→ *3+ live agent integrations* with public case studies — ChatGPT App, Perplexity Plugin, Claude integration
→ *10,000+ contributors* (creators + expert evaluators), *500+ brands*, all organic
→ trust study preprinted on arXiv by Demo Day — "people trust agent recommendations more when those recommendations read Giftly signal"

*post-Demo Day*
OCT 2026 → JUL 2027

→ trust study peer-reviewed
→ *4+ agent surfaces* live with measurable share of recommendations
→ network compounds: *1,500+ brands*, expert evaluators across *15+ verticals*
→ seed round closed at *$5–8M*

WHAT WE NEED

# *$250k*. 12-month runway. 3 technical founders.

## BUCKETS

**survival** — *$108k*
3 founders × $36k × 12mo · SF cost-of-living minimum

**GTM + scaling** — *$112k*
see right →

**legal / G&A** — *$15k*
Clerky · contributor agreements · FTC compliance

**reserve** — *$15k*
tight on purpose

## SCALING BLOCK ($112K)

**brand acquisition** — *$40k*
Smartlead + Apollo + Clay + 20 warmed sending accounts ($25k) · founder-led BD travel ($15k)

**agent integration + trust study** — *$55k*
LLM API for eval bench + matching ($45k) · integration tooling ($5k) · AI Engineer Summit + Anthropic event ($5k)

**platform + verification** — *$17k*
Supabase + Vercel + monitoring + domains ($7k) · contributor verification, fraud detection, identity attestation ($10k)

*3 technical founders. founders build. capital pays for the network and the trust study.*

THE BET

# *the future of agentic commerce will run on Giftly.*

THE TRUST LAYER FOR AGENT COMMERCE

trygiftly.com

# they've already *said* they won't.

> OPENAI ON INSTANT CHECKOUT
>
> *"product results are organic and unsponsored, ranked purely on relevance. merchant payments don't influence ChatGPT's product results."*

the moment they pick winners, they lose *neutrality* — and neutrality is the entire reason consumers trust agents to shop. they need an external source of ground truth. right now, they're scraping it from Wirecutter and Reddit — exactly the polluted data we started Giftly to replace.

*we're not their competitor. we're the missing infrastructure.*

# wrong customer. wrong economics. wrong data.

| | |
|---|---|
| *wrong customer* | Mercor sells to AI labs (RLHF for capability training). brand-side affiliate teams are a different buyer with different sales cycle, price point, and metric. |
| *wrong economics* | Mercor pays experts hourly. we get eval data as a byproduct of brand-funded creator commissions — zero labor cost to us. capital advantage flips. |
| *wrong data* | paid evaluators with no audience produce judgment without behavioral validation. that's structurally what gameable reviews already are. |

*the real threat is a commerce platform with brand relationships. but the trust layer has to be neutral — same conflict the labs have.*

# we come from *AI capabilities*.

ENGINEERING

## Ethan Zhou

Berkeley · researcher at the Behavioral & Analytics Lab studying *how humans trust AI* to make decisions on their behalf — the core question of Giftly. *8 publications* (2 IEEE ML), patent pending.

*"the right engineer to build the foundational dataset every shopping agent will run on."*

RESEARCH + DESIGN

## Armaan Priyadarshan

Dartmouth · AI capabilities + reasoning research. lead on *ARC-AGI-3* — the frontier benchmark for agent decisions under noisy, limited data. our system has beaten frontier LLMs and is closing on human baselines.

*"Giftly is the same question at the scale of every product an agent will ever buy."*

STRATEGY + COMMERCE

## Samarjit Deshmukh

Dartmouth · debate national semifinalist, ranked *3rd of 16,000* senior year. 12 months daily research on AI × consumer commerce — data acquisition law, creator compensation, ecommerce disputes.

*"the exact knowledge this entire company rests on."*

*Ethan and Armaan: best friends since high school — apps, an earmold manufacturing business. Armaan and Samarjit: 100+ nights in the CS basement, 12 projects, 3 hackathons in SF. last week we skipped school and moved into Ethan's dorm.*

APPENDIX · 04 — PMF

# early *signals*, not yet PMF.

STAGE 1

## wedge PMF

brand × creator marketplace works — CPA contracts close, commissions flow, both sides return.

*→ early signals*

STAGE 2

## data PMF

eval dataset large + structured enough to answer interesting product-quality queries.

*→ ~1k+ structured records*

STAGE 3

## agent PMF

agents query API in production. turning it off would visibly degrade their recommendations.

*→ outreach in motion*

DEFENSIBLE EARLY SIGNALS

- *0.67%* brand cold-conversion (7/1,043) · solid for B2B
- *Apollo Neuro* inbound CPA offer — willingness-to-pay, unprompted
- *$300M* partner-tier resonance in 1 week
- *1,043* brands in active outreach

LEADING INDICATORS WE'LL PROVE OUT

- first revshare check (closes unit-economic loop)
- first inbound brand inquiry
- creator-to-creator referrals
- first agent partner technical conversation

*in active outreach: Firecrawl · Browserless · OneOff · doji · PayOS · Skyfire.*